THE SANGH STAMP

A MAJORITY OF THE NEW STATE/UT CHIEFS ARE FROM THE RSS OR THE LARGER SANGH PARIVAR. THE EXCEPTIONS ARE IN PLACES WHERE IT'S STILL NOT A DOMINANT FORCE

LADAKH
Tashi G. Kachu
Ex-PDP, returned in '19. Has strong cadre roots

JAMMU & KASHMIR
Sat Sharma
Party veteran with Sangh roots

PUNJAB
Ashwini Sharma*
From the ABVP/ RSS stable

RAJASTHAN
Madan Rathore
Rajya Sabha MP, veteran BJP face

MADHYA PRADESH
Hemant Khandelwal
RSS insider and MLA

DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI, DAMAN & DIU
Mahesh Agaria
Local leader who rose through the ranks

MAHARASHTRA
Ravindra Chavan
Strong RSS ties, four-time MLA

GOA
Damodar Naik
Two-term MLA from OBC Bhandari community; RSS man has pro-Catholic image

LAKSHADWEEP
K.N. Kasmikoya
Muslim ex-bureaucrat

UTTARAKHAND
Mahendra Bhatt
Incumbent has strong Sangh connections

HIMACHAL PRADESH
Rajeev Bindal
Experienced ex-minister with RSS links

KERALA
Rajeev Chandrasekhar
Ex-Union minister is a businessman-turned-neta. First state chief who isn't an RSS man

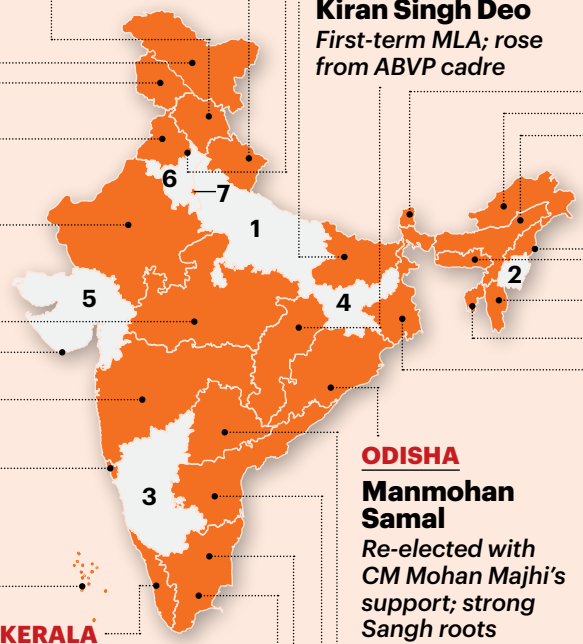
TAMIL NADU
Nainar Nagendran
AIADMK turncoat

PUDUCHERRY
V.P. Ramalingam
Former nominated MLA

CHANDIGARH
Jatinder Malhotra
Local leader of standing

BIHAR
Dilip Jaiswal
Grassroots MLA with regional influence

CHHATTISGARH
Kiran Singh Deo
First-term MLA; rose from ABVP cadre



ODISHA
Manmohan Samal
Re-elected with CM Mohan Majhi's support; strong Sangh roots

TELANGANA
N. Ramchander Rao
Ex-MLC with deep RSS links

ANDHRA PRADESH
P.V.N. Madhav
RSS/ABVP pedigree; ex-MLC

SIKKIM
Dilli Ram Thapa
Local RSS-linked representative

ARUNACHAL PRADESH
Kaling Moyong
Tribal leader with strong local appeal

ASSAM
Dilip Saikia
RSS/ABVP cred, possible counter to CM Himanta Biswa Sarma

NAGALAND
B. Yepthomi
RSS-aligned leader

MEGHALAYA
Rikman Momin
One of two Muslim state unit chiefs

MIZORAM
K. Beichhua
Ex-MNF#, three-time MLA

TRIPURA
R. Bhattacharjee
Local party leader

ANDAMAN & NICOBAR
Anil Tiwari
Local BJP organiser

WEST BENGAL
Samik Bhattacharya
Rajya Sabha MP and consensus-builder; has Sangh backing

**Working president; #Mizo National Front*

Shringla. The pattern is clear: loyalty to the Sangh and nationalist credentials will be prioritised for appointments in constitutional, cultural and legal institutions. While the BJP may be taking its time with organisational decisions, the broader ideological ecosystem is quietly strengthening its hold on the state apparatus.

THE STICKING POINTS

While 28 state units now have presidents, seven major ones remain leaderless. And this isn't just due to procedural delays, factionalism, succession tussles and the resetting of ideological control have as much to do with it.

Karnataka: The BJP's southern stronghold is grappling with a leadership crisis after setbacks in the Lok Sabha and state polls. State president B.Y. Vijayendra, son of ex-CM B.S. Yediyurappa, is taking flak from their traditional rivals. National general secretary B.L. Santhosh is a parallel power centre, rallying support from factions allied with the last BJP CM,